

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 6

**RAJPUT
DYNASTY**



CHINA

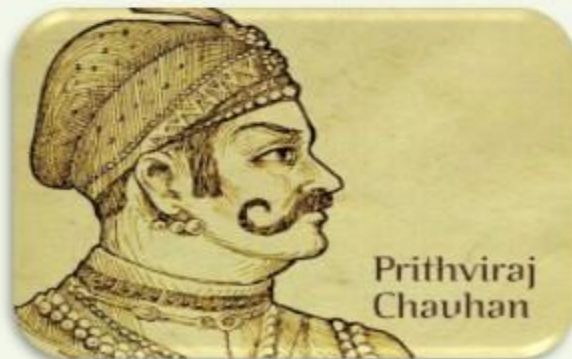
RAJPUT
DYNASTY

RAJPUT DYNASTY



RAJPUT DYNASTY

CHAUHANS OF AJMER



SIMHARAJA (944 AD—971 AD)

- 1 Founded the Chahaman/Chauhan dynasty around 10th century AD and adopted the title of Maharajadhiraja.
- 2 The most famous of all Chauhans, is popularly known as Prithviraj Chauhan or Rai Pithora in the folk legends.
- 3 He scored victories over all his neighbours, including the Chandella king Paramardi, Chalukya Bhima II and Gahadvala Jayachandra.
- 4 Ascended the throne at the young age of 11, after death of his father Someshvara, but took the reigns of administration in his hands when he was 16 years old.



TARAIN

SHAKAMBHARI

CHAUHAN

AJMER

BANGLADESH

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

RAJPUT DYNASTY

CHAUHANS OF AJMER



5 Led an expedition in Bundelkhand against the **Chandella** ruler and its capital Mahoba, and it was in this struggle the famous Chandella warriors **Alha and Udal** lost their lives.

6 Defeated **Muhammad Ghori** in the **First Battle of Tarain** in 1191 AD.

7 In 1192 AD, Muhammad Ghori defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in the **Second Battle of Tarain**, and subsequently executed him. His defeat at Tarain is seen as a landmark event in the Islamic conquest of India,

THE CHANDELLAS OF BUNDELKHAND



1 In the first quarter of the 9th century AD, the dynasty was founded by **Nannuka**, who was the ruler of a small kingdom, and established his capital at **Kharjjuravahaka (Khajuraho)**.

2 Chandellas of Bundelkhand trace their descent to a mythical ancestor named **Chandratreya**, ie. born of the moon.

3 The Chandellas initially ruled as **feudatories of the Gurjara-Pratiharas** of Kannauj, and were involved in conflicts with the Pratiharas, the Palas, and the Kalachuris of Chedi (who bordered the Chandellas on the south).



THE CHANDELLAS OF BUNDELKHAND



- 4 The Chandellas are well-known for their art and architecture, most notably for the fully developed Nagara-style temples at their original capital Khajuraho.

- 5 The Lakshmana Temple, The Vishvanatha Temple, and The Kandariya Mahadeva Temple were constructed during the reigns of Chandella rulers.

- 6 They also commissioned several water bodies, palaces and forts at other places, including their strongholds of Jayapura-Durga (modern Ajaigarh), Kalanjara (modern Kalinjar), and their later capital Mahotsava-Nagara (modern Mahoba).

- 7 The Chandella power declined because of the rising Islamic influence, as well as the rise of other local kingdoms.

THE PARMARAS OF MALWA



- 1 The Paramaras of Malwa were originally based in the Mount Abu area of Rajasthan.
- 2 Paramara rulers were feudatories of the Rashtrakutas of Manyakheta.
- 3 Paramaras moved their capital to Mandapa-Durga (now Mandu)
- 4 Paramara kings were Shaivites and built several Shiva temples, although they also patronised Jain scholars.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

THE PARMARAS OF MALWA

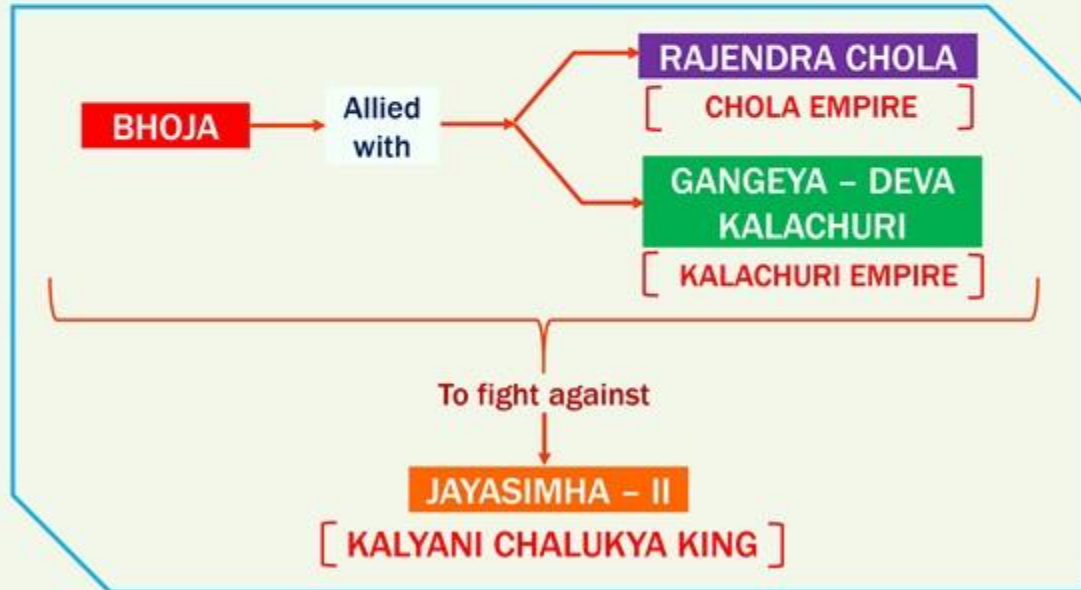


BHOJA (1010AD—1055 AD)

- 1 Bhoja is the most celebrated ruler of the Paramara dynasty, under whom the dynasty reached its zenith.
- 2 Under his reign, the Paramaras extended their kingdom from Chittor in the north to upper Konkan in the south, and from the Sabarmati River in the west to Vidisha in the east.
- 3 Around 1018 AD, he defeated the Chalukyas of Lata in present-day Gujarat.
- 4 Between 1018 AD and 1020 AD, he gained control of the northern Konkan.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

THE PARMARAS OF MALWA



BHOJA (1010AD—1055 AD)

- 5 Formed an alliance against the Kalyani Chalukya King Jayasimha II, with Rajendra Chola and Gangeya-deva Kalachuri.
- 6 During the last years of Bhoja's reign, around 1042 AD, Jayasimha's son and successor, Someshvara I, invaded Malwa and sacked its capital Dhara.
- 7 Adopted the title of Parameshvara-Parama-bhattaraka, which is considered to be identical to the title of Paramara- Deva.
- 8 It is also believed that Bhoja may have also contributed troops to support the Hindu Shahi ruler Anandapala's fight against the Ghaznavids.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

THE CHAULUKYAS OF GUJARAT/ THE SOLANKI RAJPUTS



- 1 The Solanki Rajputs are also known as the Chaulukya family of Gujarat, which was different from the earlier *Chalukyan dynasty of Badami*.
- 2 It ruled parts of Gujarat and Kathiawar between 950 AD and 1300 AD.
- 3 Unlike the *Chalukyas of Kalyani and Vengi*, the Solankis never claimed a shared descent or any other association with the original Chalukya dynasty.
- 4 Interestingly, they never used the term 'Chalukya' to describe themselves, but chose to use its variant, 'Chaulukya'.



PAKISTAN

NEPAL

Learning Space

**SOLANKI
EMPIRE**

ANAHILAVADA

MODHERA

**KATHIAWAR
REGION**

INDIA

Learning Space

Arabian Sea

RAJPUT DYNASTY

THE CHAULUKYAS OF GUJARAT/ THE SOLANKI RAJPUTS



BHIMA - I (1022AD—1064AD)

- 1 During his reign, Mahmud of Ghaznavi overran Gujarat and plundered Somnath in 1025 AD.
- 2 He built the Sun temple of Modhera.
- 3 His wife Udaymati built the Rani-ki Vav (Queen's step well) in his memory, which is on the list of UNESCO's World Heritage Sites.
- 4 It is pertinent to note here, that out of the five famous Dilwara temples, one Vimal Vasahi Temple dedicated to Jain lord Rishabha was built in 1031 AD by Vimalsha, a minister of Bhima I.



Vimal Vasahi Temple, Mount Abu



Rani Ki Vav

RAJPUT DYNASTY

THE CHAULUKYAS OF GUJARAT/ THE SOLANKI RAJPUTS



BHIMA-II (1177AD—1240AD)

- 1 He successfully repelled the incursions of **Muhammad Ghori**, who had the ambition of repeating the act performed by Mahmud of Ghazni.
- 2 In 1195—97 AD, an army led by **Aibak**, Ghori's deputy, invaded again, but Bhima II defeated Aibak again and adorned himself as **Abhinav Siddharaj**.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

THE TOMARS



1 The Tomars ruled the Hariyana (Haryana) country with their capital at Dhillika (Delhi) and they are believed to be a feudatory of the Pratiharas.

2 Medieval literature names the dynasty as “Tuar” and classifies them as one of the 36 Rajput clans.

3 They often had conflicts with the Chahamanas of Shakambhari.

4 The Tomars were associated with the construction of the earliest surviving waterworks in the Delhi area.

5 Several historians credit Tomar for the broad design of the city of Delhi and we can still see the layouts created by Tomars even today.

6 Similarly, the famous Suraj Kund reservoir (near Faridabad, Haryana) is said to have been commissioned by a Tomara king named Surajpala.



**TOMAR
EMPIRE**



DHILLIKA

THE GAHADAVALAS OF KANNAUJ



- 1 The Gahadvalas or Gaharwars, who claimed to be **Suryavanshi Kshatriyas**, ruled the kingdom of Kannauj for approximately a hundred years, beginning in the late 11th century.
- 2 Interestingly, **the Rathore clan** of the Rajputs claimed descent from the Gahadvala dynasty.
- 3 **CHANDRADEVA** founded the Gahadavala dynasty of Kannauj around 1090 AD. They gradually squeezed the Palas out of Bihar and made **Banaras a second capital**.
- 4 **JAICHANDRA** (1170 AD- 1194 AD) was the last great king of the Gahadavala dynasty. During his reign, the Chauhans from Ajmer under Prathviraj Chauhan annexed Delhi.

THE GAHADAVALAS OF KANNAUJ



- 5
- According to some legends, Prithviraja loved Samyukta, daughter of Jaichandra.
 - After opposition from her father (as Prithviraj was heir to the rival Chauhan Rajput kingdom to the west), Samyukta eloped with Prithviraj.

- 6
- This further aggravated the dissension between the kingdoms, and Jaichandra then sought help from Muslims of the north to invade the Chauhans of Ajmer—Delhi.
 - This romantic tale is the subject of a lot of folklore.

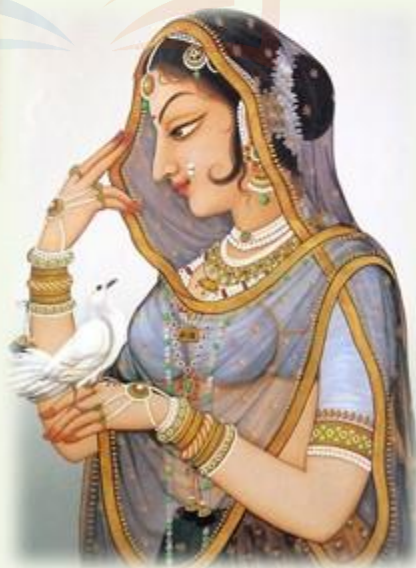
- 7
- After the fall of Delhi, around 1194 AD, the city of Kannauj was attacked by Muhammad of Ghori.

- 8
- It is believed that Jaichandra was defeated in the Battle of Chandawar (Firozabad) and subsequently drowned in the Ganga.
 - His kingdom was conquered and sacked by Ghori's armies.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY

GENERAL CONDITIONS OF THE PEOPLE



- 1 Feudalism was the dominating feature of the society.
- 2 There was a great disparity in the standard of living of the people.
- 3 The ministers, officials, feudal chiefs, and those having the opportunity to accumulate wealth lived in luxury and splendour.
- 4 They adorned their bodies with costly clothes, Chinese silk, jewels and ornaments of gold and silver.
- 5 They lived in imposing houses of several storeys competing with the grandeur of palaces

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY



- 1 A train of servants attended to their needs and comforts and a large number of women in their household glorified their super status.
- 2 The ordinary people had to remain contented with rice and wild vegetables that they could procure.
- 3 The peasants were burdened with the land revenue and other taxes levied at the whims of the feudal lords.

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY



CASTE SYSTEM

- 1 During this period the disabilities which the lower castes suffered, increased.
- 2 Most of the workers like weavers, fishermen, barbers, etc. as well as tribal were treated very harshly.
- 3 Rajputs as a new caste had appeared on the scene.
- 4 In course of time, all ruling families belonging to various castes were classified as Rajputs.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY

CONDITION OF WOMEN



- 1 Women suffered from several handicaps, although their honour was very dear to the Rajputs.
- 2 They continued to be denied the right to study the Vedas.
- 3
 - Women of higher families received higher education.
 - They followed higher ideals.
 - They gladly immolated themselves along with the dead bodies of their husbands.
 - This practice later degenerated and 'Sati-pratha' emerged in another form.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY

CONDITION OF WOMEN



- 4 Earlier there was the 'Johar' ceremony wherein the women immolated themselves 'en-masse' on a burning pyre.
- 5 There was no 'purdah' system.
- 6 'Swayamvar' type of marriage was in vogue in several royal families.
- 7 Infanticide and early marriage of girls came into practice.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY

ART AND ARCHITECTURE



- 1 The Rajput's were great patron of art and architecture.
- 2 Nagara Style temple building reached its climax under the Rajputs' rule.
- 3 They built several canals, dams, forts, palaces, temples and towers.
- 4 The palaces of Jaipur and Udaipur and forts of Chittor, Mandu, Jodhpur and Gwalior are the fine specimens of palace and fort architecture.

RAJPUT DYNASTY

SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT DURING RAJPUT DYNASTY

ART AND ARCHITECTURE



- 5 The Lingaraj Temple at Bhubaneswar and Surya (Sun) Temple at Konark exhibit the excellence of temple architecture.

- 6 Khajuraho has several famous temples including the Kandariya Mahadeva Temple.

- 7 Among the many Jain temples, two at Dilwara at Mount Abu are exemplary.

- 8 Among the historical works, Kalhana's 'Rajtarangini' a history of Kashmir and Chand-bardai's 'Prithviraj Raso' dealing with the exploits of his patron Prithviraj Chauhan, is worth mentioning.

REASONS FOR THE DEFEAT OF RAJPUTS



1 The lack of unity among Rajput's, who were divided by factions and constant infighting.

2 Hindu states were declining in power with out of date military methods. They relied on the slow elephants while the Muslims took to fast cavalry.

3 There was better organization and able leadership under Muslim kings. Religious zeal to spread Islam and the greed for wealth provided stimulus to the Muslims.

4 Hindu Kingdoms always took a defensive position, which is a weaker stance against strategic attack and retreat strategy of Muslim invaders.

5 The duty of fighting in India was restricted to just one class — the Kshatriyas.

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